

Secondary School Examination – 2015(Annual)

ENGLISH

Time: 03 Hrs, 15 minutes

[Full Marks: 100]

SECTION-A

1. Read the passage carefully and answer the question below in your words. 4x3=12

Mount Abu's chief claims to fame are the Jain temple architecture at Dilwara, about 5 km. from Nakki Lake. Dilwara temples are one of the finest Jain temples and many even consider them architecturally superior to the Taj Mahal Built between 11th and 13th Century, the most outstanding features is its exquisite carvings in marble. The two temples, Vimala Vasahi and Luna Vasahi, are singled out by experts as superb examples of architecture.

The architecture is marked by carvings that are not just aesthetically beautiful in form but are often presented in a highly poetic context. For example, one of the marble nayikas is depicted as having just emerged from her bath. The most outstanding feature of Jain temple architecture is its carvings and understatement. The pillars, ceilings, walls and floor of Jain temples are made of marble and rock. The architecture work is shown in marbles and rocks too. This is the reason why the temples in Mount Abu and Raunakpur are said to be the finest Jain temples in the world.

Questions:

- (i) Where are the Jain temples of Mount Abu located and why are these famous for?
- (ii) What are the outstanding features of these temples?
- (iii) When were these temples built and compared with Taj Mahal?
- (iv) Find a word in the passage which means 'surpassing'?

Solution 1:

(i) The Jain temples of mount Abu are located at Dilwara, about 5 km from Nakki Lake. These are famous for architecturally superiority.

(ii) These temples have exclusive carvings.

(iii) This is made of marbles and Taj Mahal is also made of marbles.

(iv) Exacusive.

2. Read the passage carefully and answer the question below in your words. 4x2=8

Once upon a time there, was an old man. He had four sons. They used to quarrel with one another. They did not pay heed to their father's advice. An idea took place in the mind of the old man to draw his all four sons on the right track. He called all his sons. He placed a bundle of wood sticks before them. He asked each of them to try in turn and hack the bundle. Each of them tried but failed in doing so. The old man then asked them to untie the bundle and break the sticks separately. Not to speak of the oldest, even the youngest one broke the sticks without any difficulty. Then the old man told his sons that they should see the power of unity. If they lived united, no harm would come to them. If they quarrelled, they would have to face difficulty. All the four sons of the old man made out the real meaning of unity and started living unitedly with a great affection.

Questions:

- (i) How many sons had the old man and what was their behaviour with one another?
- (ii) Did they pay heed to their father's advice?
- (iii) What did the old man do next?
- (iv) What moral do you get from the above passage?

Solution 2:

- (i) The old man had four sons and they used to quarrel with one another.
- (ii) No. They do not heed their father's advice.
- (iii) In order to draw his four sons on the right track he called them and given a bundle of stick to break.
- (iv) We got moral lesson from the above lesson that we should live in unity.

Section B

Question 3: Write a letter to your elder brother in about 80 words informing him that you are going to a historical tour with your teacher.

OR

Write a letter to your younger brother congratulating him on his grand success in the Board Examination.

Solution 3:

Station Road
Kankarbag
Patna
January, 2015

Respected Brother,

I am quite well with my colleagues in my school hostel and hope you will be the same with the members of family at home.

Through this letter I am going to get you recognised that I, with my school mates, am going to a historical tour with my geography teacher. There I with my friends, get a glimpse of this place and learn a lot. Such historical tour is too much fruitful for a student to.

Convey my best regards to my elders and blessings to my Youngers.

Yours Faithfully

Rajesh

Address:

Mr. Ramesh Chandra,
Yamuna Nagar
Delhi

OR

Kankarbag
Patna
January, 2015

Dear friend Mahesh,

By the extreme grace of God I am quite well with my family members at my home. I hope you will be the same at your home too.

I, Mr. Rupesh, am going to attach my heartiest congratulation on your grand success in the Board exam. My joys knew no bounds to know about your achievement in the exam. I pray God for your coming such grand success in your life too. The more I will write to you in the next letter.

Yours truly,

Mr. Rakesh

Question 4: Write a paragraph on any one of the following in about 60 words.

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- (i) The importance of trees.
- (ii) Hostel life.
- (iii) A village fair.
- (iv) Pollution.

Solution 4:

(i) The Importance of trees

Trees play important role. They are main features of human's survival. We need oxygen which is released by trees. There is no chance to survival on earth. It gives us fire in winter and shed in summer. It provides us flower and fruits. It cause rain and gives shelter in wild animals. Although all animals do not eat plants directly. Yet, eat indirectly, food chain depends upon trees and plants. It prevents flood. It gives us natural beauty. Furniture is made of tress which give us house a pleasant look. Even books and copies are made of trees. The importance of trees can't described ultimately.

(ii) Hostel Life:

Hostel life does not homely comfort but it has several advantages. It forms healthy habits and provide great facilities for students. The students living in a hostel are not free to do whatever they like. They have to follow a fixed routine. They have to study in fixed time. The students learn a lot about human nature and social life as they live with fellow students from different social backgrounds. They share the joy and sorrow of one another. Hostel life developed more qualities. Which prove very useful in later life. It strengthens character and lays the foundation of good citizenship. It teaches the virtues of love and co-operation, which last throughout life.

(iii) A village fair:

The fair which takes place in the heart of the country side in a week or fortnight is called a village fair. A number of shops are established for a time being Goods, sold in these shops, are of village people's requirements. People from nearby areas come and buy their essential goods here. They enjoy this fair very much. Really it is a very busy day for local people. They meet each other. So a village market is of great use for the villagers. They have not to go to the towns for buying and selling things. Such fair is the part of an open place too.

(iv) Pollution:

When the word pollution structures any one's mind he starts shivering with impending dangers of pollution. It is such a domain which is fulfilment the existence of human beings and other living beings. Pollution is of different kinds. They are known as water pollution, air pollution, sound pollution, soil pollution, etc. Water is being polluted by factories and big drains. Conement water is thrown by them and pollute it. Now a days a lot traffics are funning on the road and produce loud voice and create sound pollution. By summing up those points, we reach on such a state and compel to prevent such a demon to save us from rain.

Question 5:

You are Chandan, the Secretary of the Cultural Society. You want to organise an award – giving function in your school. Write a notice in about 80 words inviting the students to attend the award-giving function.

OR

On summer vacation you have visited your village and watched the mango orchard there. Write a paragraph on the mango trees that are found in your village.

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Solution 5:

Notice: 17 March, 2015 Award – Giving Function

Our school is going to organise an award giving function at 8 p.m. 12th February 2015. The winners of the dancing competition are awarded by the famous playback dancer Kumar Sonu who will be the chief guest. He will also dance and entertain us on this occasion. For more details, contact the undersigned.

Chandan Kumar,
Secretary
Cultural Society

OR

I, Mr. Shanker Sir, have visited my native village which is situated really in the lap of nature. I have spent my whole summer vacation there. There is nothing but trees there. They are quite verdant and gracing the beauty of my native village. Mango groves are also found there. My house is also situated in a mango orchard. A number of mangoes trees are in this orchard. They are in order. They are laden with mangoes. They look beautiful and make the atmosphere cool. They provide us fruit to eat. Really the scenery of a village is far different from a town or city too.

Section C

Question 6: Do as directed: -

4x1=4

- (a) She is to eat bread. (Change into Passive voice)
- (b) The day is too hot for the old. (Remove too)
- (c) Who does not know Bapu (into assertive)
- (d) She is one of the most intelligent girls. (Into Comparative degree)

Solution 6:

- (a) Bread is to be eaten by her.
- (b) The day is so hot that the old cannot go out.
- (c) Everybody knows bapu.
- (d) She is more intelligent than many others girls.

Question 7: Change the following sentences into indirect into form of speech. 3x1=4

- (i) She said, "The sun rises in the east."
- (ii) Mohan said to Ram, "Stand up on the bench."
- (iii) He said to me, "Who has done this work?"
- (iv) He said, "Bravo! Our children have done well."

Solution 7:

- (i) She said that the sun rises in the east.
- (ii) Mohan ordered Ram to stand up on the bench.
- (iii) He asked me who had done that work.
- (iv) He shouted with applause that their children had done well.

Question 8: Fill in the blanks with appropriate form of verbs given in the bracket: 3x1=3

- (i) I wish I _____ a king. (Was/were)
- (ii) Many a man _____ visited him. (Has/had)
- (iii) The poor _____ honest by nature. (is, are)

Solution 8:

- (i) were
- (ii) has
- (iii) are

Question 9: Fill in the blanks with suitable preposition given in the bracket: 4x1=4

- (a) He gets _____ in the morning. (to, up)
- (b) We are sitting _____ the wall. (at, on)
- (c) He kills the tiger _____ a gun. (by, with)
- (d) Ravi writes _____ ink. (with, in)

Solution 9:

- (a) up
- (b) on
- (c) with
- (d) in

Question 10: Translate any five of the following into English. 5x1=5

- (i) पॉलिथीन घुलता नहीं है।
- (ii) मैं तुम्हें सुचना देने आया हूँ।
- (iii) वह बाजार गया है।
- (iv) गंगा एक पवित्र नदी है।
- (v) पटना गंगा के किनारे बसा हुआ है।
- (vi) वह कलम से लिख सकती है।
- (vii) उसकी आवाज बहुत प्यारी है।
- (viii) हम उन्हें एकटक देख रहे थे।

Solution 10:

- (i) Polythene does not dissolve,
- (ii) I have come to inform you.
- (iii) He has gone to market.
- (iv) The Ganga is a holy river.
- (v) Patna is situated on the bank of the Ganga.
- (vi) She can write with a pen.
- (vii) Her voice is very sweet.
- (viii) We are gazing at them.

Section D

Question 11: Read the extract carefully and answer the following questions: 5x1=5

I have several pet animals and birds and all of them are quite fond of me, but I don't remember any of them daring to eat from my plate.

Gillu was an exception. The moment I would reach the dining-room, he would emerge from the window, cross over the courtyard wall and the verandah, reach the table and would want to sit in my plate. With great difficulty, I taught him to sit close to my plate. His favorite food was he would dexterously eat each grain of rice. His favorite food was kaju and when not available for several days, he would refuse other food items and threw them down from the swing.

Questions:

- (i) Who is the narrator of this passage?
- (ii) What does the narrator say about her pet animals and birds?
- (iii) What would Gillu do when the narrator would enter the dining room?
- (iv) What lesson did the narrator teach Gillu?
- (v) Find a word in the passage, which means 'skilfully'.

Solution 11:

- (i) Mahadevi Verma.
- (ii) The narrator says about her pet animals and birds are very fond of her but none of them dare to eat from her plate.
- (iii) When the narrator would enter the dining room he would emerge from cross over the courtyard wall reach the table and would sit in her place.
- (iv) The narrator would teach Gillu to sit close to her plate.
- (v) Exception.

Question 12: Read the extract carefully and answers the following questions- 5x1=5

I saw a play in Dublin not long ago in which the Chief Character was an elderly corn-merchant in a small Irish Country town. He was a man of many anxieties-his heart was dicky. His nephew was cheating him, his wife had the fantastic notion of spending of Rs. 10 on a holiday. Altogether the pace of life was getting too much for him, and in a moment of despair he uttered a great cry from the heart, "They tell me there is an aeroplane now that goes at 1,000 miles an hour. Now that is too fast!"

For me that was the most enchanting line in the paly – the man's complaint was so gloriously irrelevant to his own situation. And besides being comic, it struck me as a perfect illustration of the way the Irish get at subtle truths by the most unlikely approaches. You saw what the old fool meant.

Questions:

- (i) Name the tittle and the writer of the passage.
- (ii) What kind of a man was the corn- merchant?
- (iii) What was his nephew doing?
- (iv) What was his anxieties?
- (v) What was the most enchanting line in the play for the writer?

Solution 12:

- (i) The pace for living R.C. Hulchinson.
- (ii) The corn merchant was a man of many anxieties.
- (iii) His nephew was cheating him.
- (iv) His anxieties were that his nephew was cheating him and his wife spending Rs. 10 on a holiday.
- (v) The most enchanting line in the play for the writer was they tell neither is an aeroplane now that goes at 1,000 miles an hour, Now, that's too fast.

Question 13: Answer any one of the following in about 80 words-

2x3=6

- (i) What did the narrator, Mahadevi Verma, do with the wounded squirrel?
- (ii) What is the most dominant influence on Indian films?
- (iii) How is the Indian culture different from the cultures of other countries?

Solution 13:

(i) One morning, Mahadevi Verma, the narrator of the story 'Gillu' saw that two crows were poking their beaks at the flowerpots. She went there and recovered a baby squirrel from them. He was badly wounded. She washed his wound and applied pencilling on it. She tried to feed him by putting a thin cotton wool wick, dipped in milk to his mouth. The result was that he looked better and able to open his mouth. After several hours the narrator managed to pour one drop of water in his mouth.

(ii) The most dominant influence on Indian films is the technique of film production in Hollywood every phase of American cinema has been reflected in Indian films. Indian films are based on Indian stories and the background of the music is also based on the Indian music. The high technical polish of good Hollywood film can be achieved under Indian conditions. So, the invitation of Hollywood film has not been good for Indian films.

(iii) By far Indian Culture is different from the cultures of other countries. It is remarkable for unity and continuity. It has a unique capacity of absorbing external influence. Many tribes with their own civilizations and culture came to India. Our culture absorbed their influences. This is why 'Unity of diversity' is found in Indian culture. It has the capacity of readjustment and toleration. All classes are equally cultured in India. This is why Indian culture is different from the cultures of other countries.

Question 14: Answer the following Question in about 30 words each-

2x2=4

- (i) In which situation, does R.C. Hutchinson find himself in the cinema?
- (ii) Why did Akoulya shout a Malasha?
- (iii) What is the old woman's position in the neighbourhood?
- (iv) What is more precious than diamond or silver or gold?

Solution 14:

- (i) Once R.C. Hutchinson visits the cinema. He is not able to follow the fast movement of the story and rapid changes of scene and action. He is compelled to seek his wife's help in order to keep up with the rapid movement of the plot. So, all the finds himself in hopeless situation in the cinema.
- (ii) One day some young people visit her because they want to prove that she is fraud who cheats people. They believe that she does not really have the power of seeing in the mind the events of the future.
- (iii) There was an old woman live in her village. She is prettyful woman. She lives together. She helped each other I neighbour. The old woman is very good position in his neighbour.
- (iv) The beauty of genuine brotherhood and peace is more precious than diamond or silver or gold. Diamond, silver and gold are precious metals but they cannot make necessary than these material things for the survival of the human race.

Question 15: Read carefully the stanza given below and answers the questions that follow
4x1=4

Our groves were planted to console at noon
The pensive wanderer in their shades. At eve
The moonbeam, sliding softly in between
The sleeping leaves, is all the light they wish,
Birds warbling all the music. We can spare

- (i) From which poem have these lines been taken?
- (ii) Why were groves planted?
- (iii) What for 'Our' stands in the first line?
- (iv) What is the source of light in the village at evening?

Solution 15:

- (i) God made the country.
- (ii) Groves were planted to control us.
- (iii) For 'our' first line stands that plants is very necessary for human life.
- (iv) The moon beam is the source of light in the village in the evening.

Question 16: Answer any two of the following questions in about 40 words- **2x3=6**

- (i) Why does the poet believe that God made the country?
- (ii) Why does the poet call the Koel 'a rain of sparks'?
- (iii) What does the poet want to live and die stealthily? Why?
- (iv) What was the reason of man's death?

Solution 16:

- (i) The poet believes that God made the country because the country side is full of natural beauty, trees and birds. Life in the countryside is simple and peaceful.
- (ii) The poet calls the Koel 'a rain if spark' because her- pitched notes kindle fire.
- (iii) According to the poet, life has become restless due to more population and desire of getting more and more. Unless a man controls his greed and wants, art get a happy life. That's why the poet wants to live unseen and unknown and die unlamented.
- (iv) There are many reason for man death. When accident, not able to money for drugs. In a long the not formed of food and water. In last when age are very old then man as soon as death.

Question 17: Answer any one of the following question:

1x6=6

- (i) Mr. Gesster was not successful in his trade. Why?
- (ii) Who was Munni? Why did she ask her husband to give up tenant farming?

Solution 17:

(i) Mr. Gessler was a skilled shoemaker and famous for his perfect and long life boots. He gave much time in preparing a pair of boot. The result was that made shoes or boot was an exquisite one. He was quite unable to understand the tricks of modern business. The big firms of the shoes took away the work from him. Now he was left with very little work. That's why he was not successful in his trade.

(ii) Munni was the wife of Halku, a poor tenant farmer. Her husband was quite unable to save enough money for food and clothes after paying rent to the landlord. His wife was a strong hearted woman. She knew well that it was difficult to live from her husband in cold winter night without a blanket. She also advised him to give up tenant farming because this was killing him. She uttered again if he worked as a hired labour, he would get enough food to eat.

Question 18: Answer any two of the following question:

1x4=4

- (i) Why did the banker weep to read the notes of the lawyer?
- (ii) Why did Halku need a blanket?
- (iii) How did Moon's shoes look like?
- (iv) Was the narrator honest in his relation with the girl?

Solution 18:

- (i) The banker wept to read the notes of the lawyer because he was filled with guilt. He also felt contempt himself and repented for it too.
- (ii) Halku had to look after his crops by sleeping there. He had also to face the bitter and pinching cold night. That was why he needed a blanket.
- (iii) Moon's shoes looked very beautiful because they were white with big blobs on them.
- (iv) The narrator was a weak hearted coward man who did not have courage to fight with any adverse situation so he was in fix. But ultimately he left the girl for the sake of castism and other reasons. This show that he was not honest relation.